

ImmunoShield Access Guide

Prior Authorization and Patient Assistance — Internal Use Only

Overview

ImmunoShield is an immunology therapy indicated for rheumatoid arthritis, psoriatic arthritis, and ulcerative colitis. Given the \$4,500 per-unit acquisition cost, virtually every payer requires prior authorization and most patients benefit from one of the access programs described in this guide.

Reps should educate office staff on documentation requirements and direct patients to the access support team; reps must not submit PA paperwork or handle PHI.

Prior Authorization Process

ImmunoShield prior authorization is required by virtually every payer. Required documentation: confirmed autoimmune diagnosis with disease activity score, documented failure or intolerance of at least one TNF-inhibitor (mandatory step therapy in 90% of plans), hepatitis B and TB screening results within the past 6 months, and treatment goals.

Decisions typically take 7 to 14 business days. The manufacturer's PA support program provides electronic submission and dedicated PA specialists who follow up with payers; using this program has cut average approval time to 9 days.

Patient Assistance Programs

The ImmunoShield Patient Assistance Program (IPAP) provides ImmunoShield at no cost to uninsured or underinsured patients meeting eligibility criteria: US residents, household income at or below 400% of the federal poverty level, and no other coverage (private or public).

For commercially insured patients, the co-pay support card caps patient cost at \$5 per infusion with an annual savings cap of \$20,000. Government-insured patients (Medicare, Medicaid, TRICARE) are not eligible for the co-pay card. A foundation grant pathway exists for Medicare patients facing high coinsurance — refer the office to the access support team.